

Lab 2.b demo 4 walkthrough — reading the CI (layer 4, merge time)

The shortest demo: no build, one file to read, one question to answer. Layer 4 is **merge time** — the moment `git commit --no-verify` cannot reach, and the layer that holds against **anyone merging, agent or human**, wired clone or fresh one. ~5 minutes.

Step 1 — Read what already runs

Open [.github/workflows/ci.yml](#). On **every PR and every push to main** it runs:

```
- npm ci
- npm run lint      # includes the no-console rule for server/src
- npm run typecheck
- npm test
```

Lint, typecheck, tests: deterministic, non-AI guardrails have been holding this repo the whole time. The repo's review agent (`.claude/agents/taskboard-code-reviewer.md`) is even told **not** to re-report what these catch — the AI layer spends itself on what only it can see. Use the cheapest layer that holds.

Step 2 — Find the rule that's written but never run

One of this repo's `package.json` scripts encodes a rule that **no layer enforces**. Find it before reading on.

► The answer

Step 3 — Where your gate goes

The governance gate you build in the exercise (`.github/workflows/governance.yml` , handout §3) is a **sibling of this file** — same trigger, same Actions tab, one more check on the PR. Two things to know before you build:

- **It only runs when a PR exists.** A pushed branch alone runs nothing — open a draft PR to see it fire, or your gate will look broken when it's merely unasked.
 - **Results live in the PR's Checks tab** (or the repo's Actions tab). The run URL is this layer's evidence — the refusal text's merge-time twin.
-

Common wobbles

Wobble	The move
"My gate doesn't run"	Draft PR open? <code>on: pull_request</code> runs nothing for a bare branch
<code>git diff</code> fails with "unknown revision"	<code>fetch-depth: 0</code> on the checkout step — the default shallow clone breaks diffs against the base
Can't find the run	PR page → Checks tab, or repo → Actions tab; each run links its log per step